
URBAN REUSE / CASE HL01

THE HIGH LINE PUBLIC REALM

**From freight infrastructure
to civic operating model.**

A real case of preservation, landscape,
access, programming, and stewardship.

OFFICIAL FACTS + EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

FRIENDS OF THE HIGH LINE / 2026



The asset was already there. The operating model was not.

A linear freight structure became a public-realm question.

ELEVATED INFRASTRUCTURE / 1934 → 1980



1934

freight rail begins

1980

last train

THE PUBLIC QUESTION

Demolish, preserve, or transform?

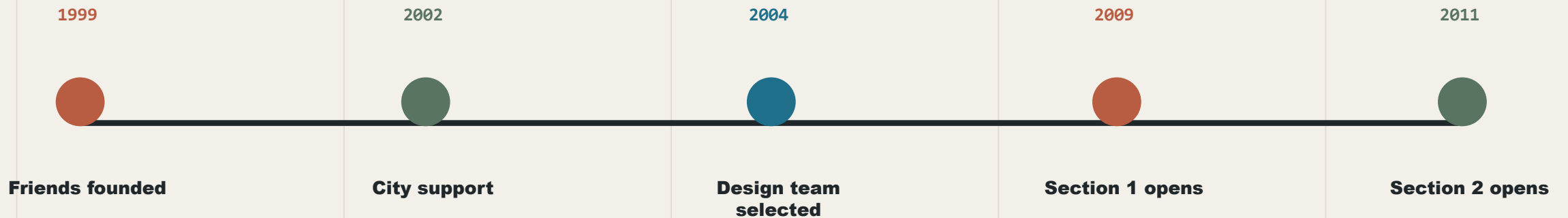
The structure carried food and agricultural goods above Manhattan streets. Its next use had to carry public life instead.

The first design move was reframing.

Preservation became a civic design process

The project advanced through advocacy, public support, design, and phased delivery.

PUBLIC PROCESS / OFFICIAL MILESTONES

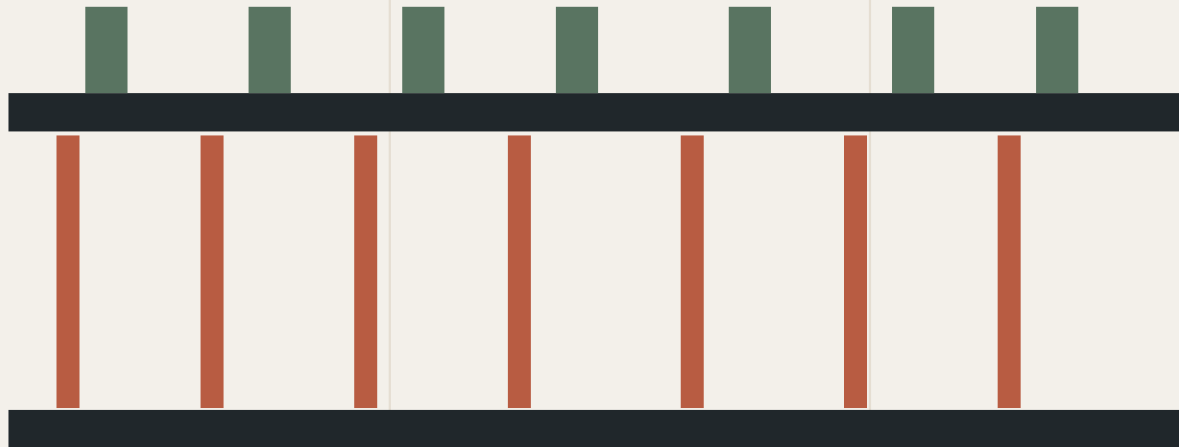


The sequence matters: legitimacy was built before the landscape was built.

The track bed became the design vocabulary

The strongest move preserved memory while changing use.

EDITABLE ELEVATED SECTION / RAIL + PLANTING



rail memory + self-seeded landscape + public movement

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

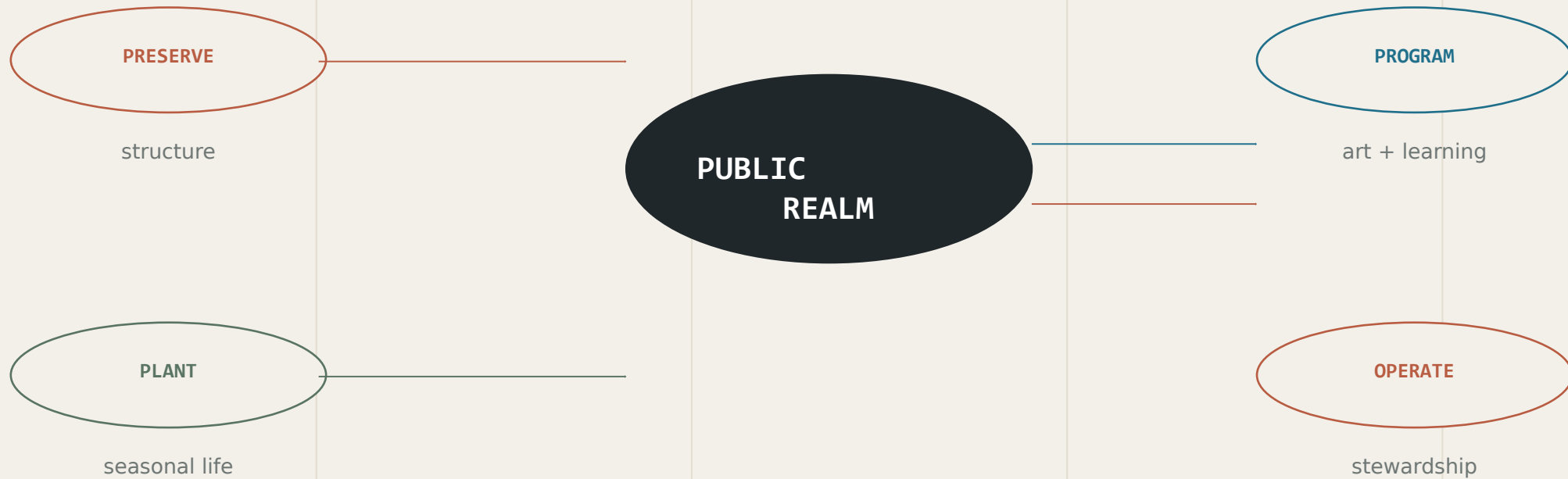
Keep the trace. Change the role.

More than one-third of the original rail tracks are featured in the park's design.

A park is not only a path

The public realm works as a linked system of access, landscape, culture, and care.

SYSTEMS MAP / NATIVE DIAGRAM

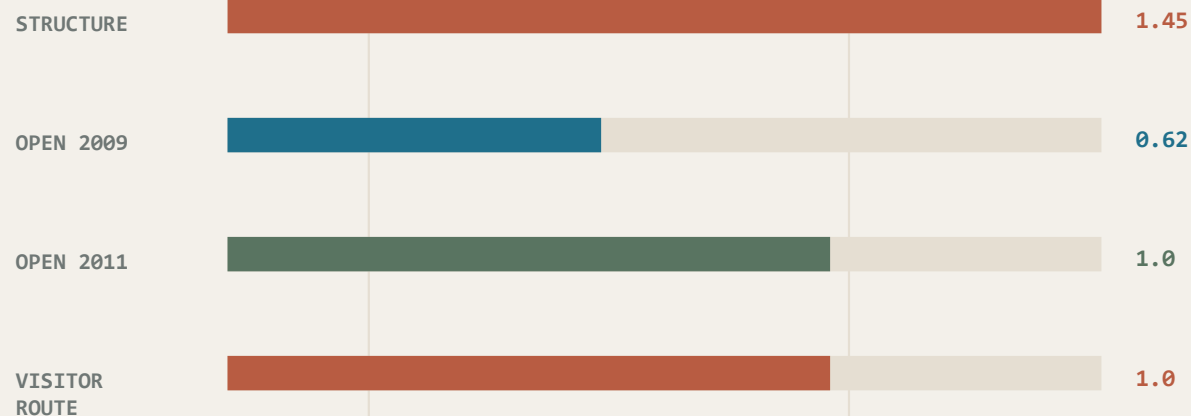


VALUE IS MAINTAINED BETWEEN THE NODES.

The park changed the value of an obsolete corridor

A single linear structure can carry many kinds of public use.

OFFICIAL SCALE / 1.45 MILES



Scale is physical. Meaning is operational.

READING

Reuse creates more than access.

It creates a platform for landscape, culture, and neighbourhood identity.

The design team was a coalition, not a single author

Landscape, architecture, planting, public agencies, and civic advocates formed one delivery system.

COLLABORATION FIELD

FIELD OPERATIONS

landscape / project lead
shared accountability

DS+R

architecture + public realm
shared accountability

PIET OUDOLF

planting design
shared accountability

CITY + FHL

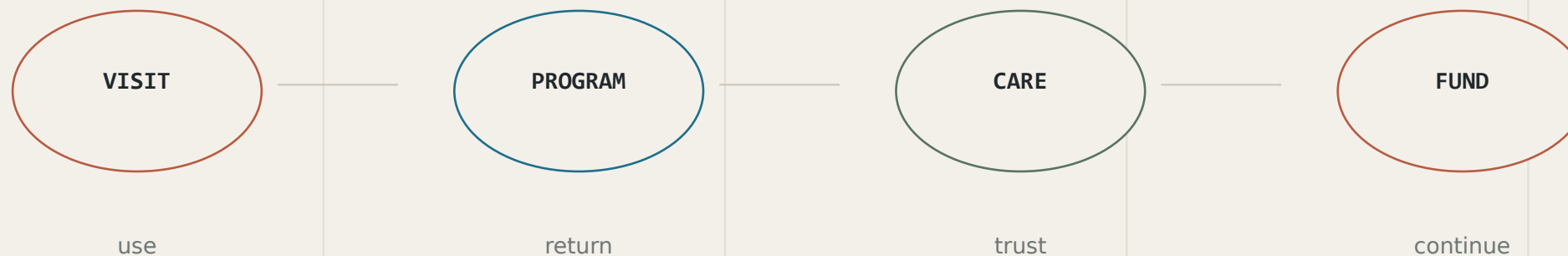
jurisdiction + stewardship
shared accountability

A memorable place requires an operating coalition behind the image.

The project did not end at opening day

Public space becomes durable when maintenance, programming, and funding are designed with it.

OPERATING LOOP / EDITORIAL MODEL

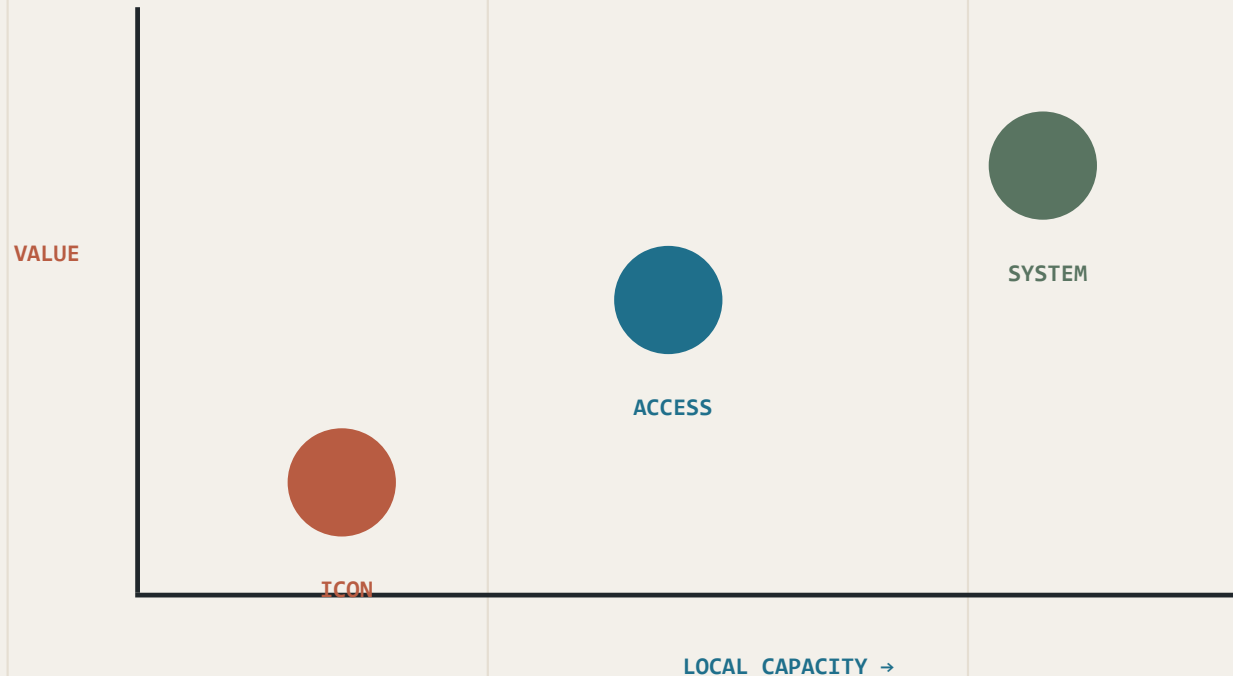


OPERATE THE PUBLIC REALM AS A LIVING ASSET.

What should another city actually copy?

The transferable lesson is the operating logic, not the visual icon.

DECISION MATRIX / TRANSFERABILITY



TRANSFER RULE

Copy the conditions, not the image.

preserve a trace
build a coalition
fund the afterlife

The High Line is a lesson in changing the role of infrastructure

Preservation became powerful when it was connected to design, stewardship, and public use.

Keep the trace. Change the role.

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- 01 **Preserve what gives the place memory.**
 - 02 **Design the system around public use.**
 - 03 **Fund the operating life after opening.**

THE BOUNDARY

The High Line is a real case.
The transfer model is analysis.
Neither is a universal formula.